

The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Rite of the Heart of Dependent Origination

Āryapratītyasamutpādahṛdayavidhīdhāraṇī · Toh 519 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྟེན་ཅིང་འབྲེ་བར་འབད་བའི་སྒྲི་པའི་ཆོ་གོ་གཟུངས་

Toh 519 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Āryapratītyasamutpādahṛdayavidhīdhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Noble Dhāraṇī of the Rite of the Heart of Dependent Origination. It belongs to the dhāraṇī class of canonical literature and centers on a sacred formula rooted in the doctrine of dependent origination, accompanied by the ritual instructions for its recitation and application for the benefit of sentient beings. The text opens with the celebrated verse summarizing the Buddha's teaching on causally arisen phenomena, situating the dhāraṇī firmly within the framework of this foundational Buddhist teaching. It was translated from Sanskrit into Tibetan by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla together with the great editor-translator, the monk Ye shes sde, and was subsequently revised in accordance with the standardized new terminology of the imperial translation period.

Translated by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra, Dānaśīla, and the great editor-translator, the monk Ye shes sde; revised and finalized in accordance with the new terminology.

In the Indian language: Āryapratītyasamutpādahṛdayavidhīdhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Rite of the Heart of Dependent Origination.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Those phenomena which arise from causes —
their cessation from those causes
the Tathāgata has declared.
Thus spoke the great renunciant.

The rite for establishing this formula,
which brings benefit to sentient beings
and accomplishes every aim —
this the Tathāgata has perfectly proclaimed.

O sons of good family, whoever first
arouses in the Blessed One, the buddha,
a mind of reverence and faith —

the Blessed One has declared
the rite of profound dependent origination,
proclaimed in harmony with all actions,
and spoken the words of initial entry.

Thus it is: when karma and afflictions exist,
sentient beings wander in cyclic existence;
when karma and afflictions are absent,
they turn back from cyclic existence as well.
By this truth, may my aspiration be fulfilled.

Homage to the Buddha.

Homage to the Dharma.

Homage to the Saṅgha.

Homage to the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas as numerous as the
grains of sand in the river Ganges.

Homage to the pratyekabuddhas.

Homage to the arhats.

Homage to the stream-enterers.

Homage to the bodhisattvas headed by the noble Maitreya.

Homage to those accomplished in discipline and conduct.

Homage to the healers of sentient beings.

Homage to those accomplished in jewels.

As follows: Namō ratnatrayāya. Oṃ ye dharmā hetuprabhavā hetun teṣāṃ
tathāgato hyavadat, teṣāṃ ca yo nirodha evaṃ vādī mahāśramaṇaḥ svāhā.

For the rites of all activities,

recite these verses.

Visualize in the palm of one's hand,

in the stream of thought,

the form of the Blessed One, the buddha,

adorned with the marks of a great being,

beautified with the eighty excellent features,

and meditate on it entering the element of fire.

This the gods, too, recollect.

Now the preparatory activities are explained,
each set forth in proper sequence.

For fever, headache, eye disease,
and internal illness and all such ailments,
recite these verses and this essence-mantra many times,
then rise and, making a fist with the right hand,
apply it as a means of drawing out.
All illnesses will be healed.

For one-day, two-day, three-day,
and four-day recurrent fevers,
take white thread twisted three times
by a young girl,
recite twenty-eight times,
and tie it around the neck — one will live in ease.

For medicines that benefit illness,
recite these dhāraṇī mantras over them and administer.
For heart disease, pain in the sides,
and all internal ailments,
recite this mantra many times over water
and pour it over the patient — it brings benefit and ease.
Medicines that benefit illness,
when recited over and administered, bring recovery.

For mange, pustules,
boils, and open wounds,
recite this essence-mantra many times
over an anthill and apply it — one recovers.

For rectal swelling, intestinal disease, and erosive conditions,
and for pain and swelling of the genitals,
whether over a pill of barberry wood or a bodhisattva-pill,
recite twenty times and apply — it brings benefit.

For illness of whatever kind,
having assessed the severity of the sickness,
match the number of verse recitations, more or fewer, to the illness,
anoint the body and recite — it benefits.

For those struck by diarrhea,
over a medicine, pill, or food,
recite seven or twenty times,

and give it to take inwardly — it brings benefit.

The preceding recitation formulas are these. Recite them repeatedly:

Namo ratnatrayāya. Oṃ ye dharmā hetu-prabhavā hetun teṣāṃ tathāgato hy
avadat, teṣāṃ ca yo nirodha evaṃ vādī mahāśramaṇaḥ svāhā.

Reciting these, all illnesses will heal. That is the healing of illnesses.

Then once more the Blessed One declared:

For the crop-devouring worms, beetles, and grubs,
for sparrows, mice, locusts,
and all vermin that eat barley, wheat, lentils,
rice, peas, bean-pods,
fruits, grapes, and āmalaka —
to stop their mouths,
measure the extent of the field,
then over sand, earth, and ash
recite one hundred and eight times,
and scatter it over the field and fruit trees —
all those creatures will have their mouths stopped.

When excessive rain falls,
over each individual flower offered to the Blessed One,
recite twenty-one times.
In a clean and pleasant place,
in the center of a great maṇḍala,
on top of a filled vase,
or within a clean vessel —
those purely recited flowers, when burned, will cause the rain to cease.

When fierce hail is coming,
over a fish-eye cactus branch
recite one hundred and eight times,
then swing and whip it in the direction from which the hail is moving —
whirling it about the upper part and striking, the hail will cease.

Alternatively, over a great heap of white mustard seed
recite one hundred and eight times,
fashion it into bundles, tie them onto the branch,
and plant it — the hail will cease.

For one seized by flesh-eating spirits (bhūtas), hungry ghosts (pretas), and spirits that cause forgetfulness,
set five clean vases at the four corners and center of a maṇḍala one fathom square,
fumigate with guggul incense,
prepare medicines including white mustard, camphor, sandalwood, and musk and the like,
recite one hundred and eight times,
arrange white cloth and white food,
place them within that maṇḍala,
and wash the person with the water of the vases.
With water used to bathe a buddha-image,
wash and pour it over them — it greatly benefits.
They will be freed from all illness and harm,
and flesh-eating spirits and spirits of forgetfulness will find no opportunity.

For a child terrified by a demon,
recite the mantra over yellow orpiment,
then write and attach this great and powerful essence-mantra:

Oṃ vajra-krodha mahābala, hana hana, paca bidhvaṃsaya, jaṭilaṃ bhodara,
ucchuṣma-krodha hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

Having cleaned it well, tie it about the neck.
Likewise, over white mustard seeds
recite the mantra and tie it about the folds of the garment.

When one is seized by a ḍākinī spirit,
over white mustard and guggul
recite both mantras seven times each
and fumigate — the person will recover.
Have no doubt in this.

The child will be freed from demons and illness.

When a woman is obstructed in giving birth,
recite the mantra over water five or seven times,
and pour it over her — she will deliver well.

For a barren woman or for any woman,
take the water used to bathe a buddha-image,
recite the mantra over it twenty times,
and after she has bathed and her body is clean,

pour that water over her — she will bear a son,
and her family lineage will flourish.

When setting out on a journey,
over a cord and the hem of a garment
recite the mantra seven times and tie seven knots.
Having tied the knots and recited, then set forth —
one will travel in safety, one's aims will be accomplished,
and one will be free of enemies and danger.

For one who wishes to make the mind sharp,
take a sufficient quantity of raw sugar and three hundred and sixty srang of
butter,
recite the mantra over them and mix them together,
pour them into a single vessel and stir.
Each day for one year,
over each piece of raw sugar
and each srang of butter,
recite the mantra once and eat it.
By this the mind becomes sharp and keen.

Likewise, in the same way,
over the butter and milk of a yellow-gray cow,
recite one hundred and eight times,
stir into a porridge and eat it —
it becomes the supreme means of sharpening the mind.

For one who wishes to associate with people and be loved,
take whatever flowers, grasses, plants,
fruits, or dewdrops appeal to the mind,
place them in the hollow of the right hand,
recite the mantra one hundred and eight times,
and give them to whomever you choose —
that person will always become your dear friend.

When horses and other livestock
are on the verge of death,
recite the mantra one hundred and eight times
over water mixed with white mustard seed,
then sprinkle it upon them — they will recover.

Alternatively, tie a bundle of mustard seed
over which the mantra has been recited
around their neck —
they will become free of illness and comfortable.

When people are stricken with fear of death,
recite the mantra over white mustard seed,
make it into a bundle and hang it at the door,
and recite the mantra one hundred, one thousand, or even one hundred
thousand times —
all human illness and animal illness
will vanish entirely by name, and all will be at ease.

All of these applications employ this mantra,
and it has been taught extensively throughout.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Oṃ ye dharmā hetuprabhavā hetun teṣāṃ tathāgato
hyavadat, teṣāṃ ca yo nirodha, evaṃ vādī mahāśramaṇaḥ svāhā.

If one recites this mantra constantly,
all wishes will be perfectly fulfilled,
no harm of any kind will be able to take hold,
and one will fully uphold the sacred Dharma.

These verses possess power and miraculous ability beyond conception.
All these rites, for whoever has faith and confidence in them,
will without doubt come to fruition.
If one completes one hundred thousand recitations,
every need and purpose will be accomplished.

This compassion of the Teacher Śākyamuni
was found in the land of Togar
by the monk Nerwar Rakṣita,
and has arisen as a glory for all beings.

This concludes the dhāraṇī of the rite of the essence of noble dependent
origination.

Translator's Notes

• The rite preserved here is the Āryapratītyasamutpādaḥṛdayavidhidhāraṇī, a Sanskrit dhāraṇī
text embedded in a ritual manual. The famous ye dharmā verse — "those phenomena which

arise from causes" — is one of the most celebrated Buddhist formulae; the Tibetan verse rendering is translated faithfully here rather than substituted with a standard English version, to preserve the sense of this ritual text's own literary form.

The phrase "bodhisattva-pill" renders byang chub sems dpa'i ril bu, likely a medicinal pill named after or consecrated in the name of the bodhisattvas, a recognized category in Tibetan medical and ritual literature.

"Barberry wood" renders skyerpa'i khaṇḍa, a pill or piece made from the berberis shrub, common in Tibetan medical formulations.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation reflects this exactly.

- The Ye dharmā formula is the famous Pratītyasamutpāda-dhāraṇī, here appearing in its standard Tibetan transliteration of the Sanskrit. It has been rendered in reconstructed Sanskrit as it stands rather than translated, in keeping with its function as a liturgical mantra-dhāraṇī.

The term rendered "fish-eye cactus branch" for རྩ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ is uncertain; རྩ་ལྔ་ is identified in some Tibetan botanical glossaries as a thorny or cactus-like plant, and ལྔ་ལྔ་ ("fish-eye") may refer to a variety or part of it. The precise botanical identification is unclear.

The unit སྒང་ (sraṅg) is a traditional Tibetan weight measure, retained untranslated here as "sraṅg" in the context of a medicinal/ritual recipe; converting it would introduce false precision.

- The mantra embedded in the text is the well-known Ye Dharmā dhāraṇī, the "heart of dependent origination" formula (pratītyasamutpāda hṛdaya), here rendered in transliteration from the Tibetan phonetic rendering rather than normalized Sanskrit, as the Tibetan orthography itself is non-standard but the formula is universally recognized.

The term "Togar" renders Tibetan Tho gar, a toponym of uncertain identification sometimes associated with a region to the northwest of Tibet, possibly Tukhāra (Bactria) or a related area. This is a genuine geographical uncertainty worth noting.

"Nerwar Rakṣita" renders dge slong ner ban rakṣita, the name of the monk credited with finding and transmitting this text. The first element may represent a place-name or epithet rather than a personal name, but the reading is not wholly certain.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.